

Buddy Initial Home Rehabilitation Programme

Buddy hind limb rehabilitation · Programme #1 · active

Patient: Buddy

Owner: Emma Thompson

Starts: 2026-05-27 – 2026-06-10

Notes: Initial home exercise programme created following first physiotherapy review. MSc assessment demo data.

Session 1 — AM

Morning strengthening and core control session.

Exercise	Reps	Sets	Hold (s)	Notes
Step up Five reps twice daily. Perform this exercise on a flat stable surface with your dog standing square.	6	3	—	Lead AM session with controlled forelimb loading.
Baited back stretch Neck and spine stretches on block – 2-3 stretches per direction at 7-15s hold twice daily (following heat packs where possible). Perform this action in a standing position and with a treat in hand.	3	1	7	Gentle spinal mobility exercise.
Raised sit stands Five reps thrice daily. This exercise involves a controlled, square sit onto a firm cushion a couple of inches tall with your dog's legs underneath themselves.	5	2	—	Controlled sit-to-stand strengthening.
Raised poles Five reps (there and back counts as one rep) twice daily. This exercise should be performed on a flat, non-slip surface and at an active walk. Lay X flat poles on the ground and ask your dog to walk over the centre of each.	5	1	—	Finish AM session with controlled pole walking.

Session 2 — PM

Evening mobility, balance and controlled movement session.

Exercise	Reps	Sets	Hold (s)	Notes
Weaving Three reps twice daily. Walk your dog around three markers placed 6 feet apart in a weaving pattern on a flat, non-slip surface. Maintain slow, controlled movement progressing from shallow to deeper turns to encourage spinal bending.	3	2	—	Start PM with slow weaving for spinal mobility.
Lay to stand Three reps twice daily. A controlled lay-to-stand exercise using hindlimb strength, similar to a squat. Stand in front of your dog to prevent them dragging forward with their forelimbs.	3	2	—	Controlled hind limb strengthening from down position.
Slow lead walk Three reps twice daily. Walk your dog on a short lead with a raised head at a slow, controlled pace to encourage equal weight bearing on each limb. Consider a harness if your dog struggles with pulling.	3	2	—	Promote symmetrical gait and steady loading.
Circles Three reps twice daily. Walk your dog around four markers placed 1.5 body lengths apart in a circular path, keeping your dog on the inside. Perform clockwise and anticlockwise on a flat, non-slip surface at an active walk.	3	2	—	Encourage controlled circular movement patterns.
Give paw Three reps twice daily. Ask your sitting dog to give their paw, bringing it upwards slightly to gain flexion from the elbow joint. If needed, start by picking up the limb yourself.	3	2	—	Forelimb control and gentle elbow flexion.
Raised sit stands Five reps thrice daily. This exercise involves a controlled, square sit onto a firm cushion a couple of inches tall with your dog's legs underneath themselves.	3	2	—	Repeat strengthening at end of PM session.